

Photographs by MADHUR MEHTA

Bombay, Chennai, and Pune," Kaushik explains. "It was important to have a space where they could have their own ecosystem." This move didn't just support her team; it reclaimed her time, allowing her to balance a gruelling pan-India and international travel schedule with focused studio work.

ANTI-TREND PHILOSOPHY

If there is one word that defines Kaushik's work, it is timelessness. She is a vocal critic of fast architecture, the kind of trendy design that looks dated within five years. "I always try for something that would last," she says. "Successful design shouldn't punch you in the face or knock you out after two years." This philosophy extends to her distaste for the excessive use of metal and fluting in modern homes. To her, these are often "poor taste" shortcuts that make a residence feel like an Italian furniture showroom rather than a home. "A home should not feel like you just opened the boxes and placed them. It needs personality."

SUSTAINABILITY WITH A TWIST

Kaushik's take on sustainability is refreshingly blunt. She dismisses the fad of placing just one eco-friendly light in a home or simply having a rainwater pit, as mere tips of the iceberg. To her, the greatest criminal waste of energy is a house that is demolished every 20 years because it was built on a trend or failed to anticipate a growing family's needs. "True sustainability is a home that isn't broken and remade," she asserts. By designing a timeless luxe space and ignoring the fashion of the moment, she creates assets that appreciate in design value. In facts she cites the Imperial Hotel in Delhi as a benchmark of a space that upgrades its technology without ever losing its soul or history.



